Eikev 5784

We are now in the ז’ דנחמתא, the seven weeks of comfort following תשעה באב, which continue all the way until ראש השנה. The first פסוקים of each of the haftorahs of the ז’ דנחמתא are a dialogue between הקדוש ברוך הוא and כלל ישראל. The הפטרה for עקב has two extremely important פסוקים which I would like to focus on. The first is when כלל ישראל cries to Hashem. כלל ישראל in ציון cries bitterly (Yeshayahu 49:14): וַתֹּאמֶר צִיּוֹן עֲזָבַנִי ה׳ וַה׳ שְׁכֵחָנִי. This is a bitter cry. It is not an accusation; it is a cry, a weeping: Hashem, You have forgotten us.

Towards the end of the הפטרה, there’s a פסוק which profoundly answers that cry. It’s the next to the last פסוק of the הפטרה: הַבִּיטוּ אֶל אַבְרָהָם אֲבִיכֶם וְאֶל שָׂרָה תְּחוֹלֶלְכֶם כִּי אֶחָד קְרָאתִיו וַאֲבָרְכֵהוּ וְאַרְבֵּהוּ - Look to Avraham your father, and to Sarah; תְּחוֹלֶלְכֶם - who started you off, the foundation; כִּי אֶחָד קְרָאתִיו - I called them once; וַאֲבָרְכֵהוּ וְאַרְבֵּהוּ - and I benched them and I made them multiply.

The sefer צוארי חלל, from the מעינה של תורה, brings in the name of Rav Aharon ben Chaim from Izmir, the איזמירער חסידישע רבי, a fascinating insight from the מדרש. He explains that any place in תנ״ך where it uses the expression אין לה, it means אין לה now, but in the future she will have. He gives three examples:

1) וַתְּהִי שָׂרַי עֲקָרָה אֵין לָהּ וָלָד (בראשית י״א:ל׳) - She had no children, but later Hashem answered her.
2) צִיּוֹן הִיא דֹּרֵשׁ אֵין לָהּ (ירמיהו ל׳:י״ז), and then it says וּבָא לְצִיּוֹן גּוֹאֵל (ישעיהו נ״ט:כ׳).
3) אֵין לָהּ מְנַחֵם (איכה א׳:ב׳), and then it says אָנֹכִי אָנֹכִי הוּא מְנַחֶמְכֶם (ישעיהו נ״א:י״ב) later on in the הפטרה.

So any place in תנ״ך where we have the phrase אין לה, you should know it means אין לה now, but not forever. That’s what the פסוק is saying: הַבִּיטוּ אֶל אַבְרָהָם אֲבִיכֶם - You are crying now, so think about this: look back to the first of the אבות, Avraham, and to Sarah. They were elderly, naturally unable to have children - ninety years old, long past the point of hope. It was a bitter situation.

How are we in גלות? In an even more bitter situation. We might think there is nothing coming to us - אֵין לָהּ מְנַחֵם, דֹּרֵשׁ אֵין לָהּ - we are never going to get out of this. But no, says the Navi: דֹּרֵשׁ אֵין לָהּ and אֵין לָהּ מְנַחֵם are only for now.

And what does the פסוק say? כִּי אֶחָד קְרָאתִיו - I called them; וַאֲבָרְכֵהוּ וְאַרְבֵּהוּ - just as I blessed them and they multiplied, and כלל ישראל came forth from these two individuals, so too here. Even though it says אין לה now, do not give up hope. Even in the darkest days, never give up hope. כי נחם השם ציון - in the end, Hashem will comfort ציון. It is only אֵין לָהּ מְנַחֵם now, but in the end, there will be מנחם.

The day that I’m taping this happens to be the day that the Iranian government ימח שמם came out with an announcement that they’re going to attack Israel on תשעה באב because that’s the day of their פורעניות, that’s the day that they suffer all their misfortunes. I immediately fired back to anyone who got my text message, those guys just like Haman, who didn’t know that ז’ אדר was not only a day when משה רבינו died, but ז’ אדר is the day משה רבינו was born. So too, in our time, הלוואי תשעה באב is going to become the biggest יום טוב. When you hear this podcast, this talk, it will already be after תשעה באב, and I’m hoping by then we will see a great ישועה, and Hashem will answer us and we will see the great נחמה, and הלוואי משיח should come already.

https://youtu.be/oUys_CdoUH4